Mechanisms · Word Page

Learning goal: I can identify levers, pulleys, and gears and explain how they let a small effort move a heavy load.

Words for This Lesson

mechanism: a simple machine such as a lever, pulley, or gear that changes a force

lever: a stiff bar that turns on a pivot to lift or move a load

pivot: the fixed resting point (fulcrum) that a lever turns around

pulley: a grooved wheel with a rope that changes the direction or size of a pull

How to Use These Words

Point to a word when you explain your idea.

Help: A lever uses a __ to turn a small __ force pushed over a long distance into a larger force on the __.